



YOU ARE **16 WEEKS EXACTLY**
168 days to go

YOUR BABY TODAY

As your baby's skin starts to become more waterproof, the amniotic fluid is increasingly made from urine produced by your baby's kidneys and bladder. This urine does not contain waste products, since these are transported across the placenta.

“It's natural that your partner will want to protect you and the baby, but you may need to help them get the balance right.”

Is your partner worried about you having a sip of wine or eating a tad too much chocolate, or are they constantly checking that you're getting enough rest? You may find that your partner becomes very protective of you and the baby and while some women enjoy the attention, others find it irritating.

If it bothers you, ask your partner why they feel the need to be so protective. If you can understand their feelings and concerns, it can help. Take the time tell them how you feel. Explain that pregnancy is not an illness and is a natural process, and reassure them that you're being well looked after by the doctor. For further reassurance, you could get them some reading material and involve them by inviting them along to a prenatal appointment. Encourage your partner to be involved, talk about your concerns, and include them in your prenatal visits.

STRENGTHENING YOUR LEGS

A strong and toned lower body can be achieved by doing the exercises shown below. Strengthening these muscles will make day-to-day tasks, such as walking and climbing the stairs, a lot easier as your baby grows. Strengthening your leg muscles can also help prepare you for labor positions, such as squatting.